



LISTENING

#08

1 - Listen carefully to the audio report from *Breaking News*. After listening, answer the following questions based on the information provided. Try to answer in complete sentences where possible.

Breaking News!!!

1 - Define the term "Epic Showdown."

In your own words, explain what is meant by the phrase *epic showdown*.

2 - Identify the main character.

What is the name of the boy involved in the story?

3 - True or False:

The boy was riding his bicycle when he encountered the bear.

4 - Time of Encounter

Did the boy see the bear during broad daylight or in the evening?

5 - Animal Identification

What type of bear did the boy encounter?

6 - Figurative Language

The interaction with the bear was compared to what type of game?

7 - Cause and Effect

Why did the bear get frightened during the encounter?

8 - Character Reference

What is the name of the boy's mother?

9 - Setting

Where did the event take place? Mention the specific location or region if available.

10 - Parental Advice

What does the boy's mother always remind him to be aware of?

11 - Personal Insight

According to Britney, how would most adults react in the same situation the boy faced?

Breaking News at the Train Station

It was 8:15 a.m. when the calm of the central station shattered. Commuters, sipping their coffees and scrolling through their phones, suddenly froze as the enormous overhead screen flickered red: *Breaking News*.

“Due to a security threat,” the announcer’s voice boomed, “all trains are suspended until further notice.” A wave of whispers surged through the crowd. For years, the station had been a symbol of punctuality and routine. Now, confusion replaced order.

Clara, a journalist rushing to cover an unrelated press conference, instinctively reached for her camera. News was unfolding right in front of her. People panicked not because of what had happened, but because of what *might* happen. Rumors flew faster than the trains that no longer ran.

An elderly man insisted he saw suspicious luggage near Platform 6. A mother clutched her child, demanding to know why no police were visible. Within minutes, national TV stations had arrived, broadcasting live. Clara found herself giving an impromptu interview, her trembling voice echoing across the country.

Then came the update: “The suspicious item has been secured. There is no further danger.” Relief flooded the station. Yet the fear lingered. Clara realized that *breaking news* wasn’t just about delivering facts quickly—it was about capturing a fragile moment when uncertainty holds an entire city hostage.

COMPREHENSION QUESTIONS

1 - How does the author create tension at the beginning of the story?

2 - What role does Clara, the journalist, play in shaping how the breaking news is shared?

3 - Why does the crowd react more to what *might* happen rather than to confirmed facts?

4 - What does the reaction of the mother and the elderly man reveal about human behavior in crises?

5 - What deeper reflection does Clara have about the nature of breaking news by the end of the story?
